BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #68 · HEALING AND FAITH

“Needing medication means my faith is weak.”

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Where it often comes from

Some believers are taught that faith and medicine are opposed. Taking pills can then feel like a lack of trust. Guilt sometimes leads people to stop treatment.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” Paul counseled Timothy to take a little wine for his stomach and frequent ailments. Luke was a physician, and Paul called him “beloved.” The good Samaritan used oil and wine for wounds. “The prayer offered in faith will restore the one who is sick” (James 5:15), and elders are told to pray and anoint with oil, an ancient medicinal practice. God works through prayer and through doctors and medicine. Using both is wise.

> *“Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’”* (Luke 5:31).

Also see

> “Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments” (1 Timothy 5:23).

> “Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings” (Colossians 4:14).

> “Is any one of you sick? He should call the elders of the church to pray over him and anoint him with oil in the name of the Lord” (James 5:14).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- A strong believer would trust God alone.
- Medicine shows I doubt God.
- I am cheating on faith.
- If God is my healer, I should not need pills.
- Others are healed by faith alone.
- I feel guilty taking it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must choose either faith or medicine.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that God will withdraw if I use medicine.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding my faith is weak.
- Labeling: Calling myself faithless.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn to set faith against medicine?
- What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?
- Can I thank God for the medicine He provides?
- What would my doctor advise?

- Who can pray with me as I continue treatment?
- What peace could I have in using both?

Truth summary

> Faith and medicine work together. God heals through many means, and using medicine wisely is an act of trust and stewardship. I can pray and take my treatment with thanks.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Faith
- Sickness
- Wisdom
- Guilt/Shame

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Needing medication means my faith is weak"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing medication means my faith is weak." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn to set faith against medicine?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?
- ☐ Can I thank God for the medicine He provides?
- ☐ What would my doctor advise?
- ☐ Who can pray with me as I continue treatment?
- ☐ What peace could I have in using both?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ Luke was a beloved physician.
- ☐ Prayer and medicine go together.
- ☐ God works through many means.
- ☐ I can give thanks for my treatment.
- ☐ I will follow my doctor's advice.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 5:31
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ 1 Timothy 5:23
  "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments."
- ☐ Colossians 4:14
  "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Faith and care together: Each week, thank God as you take your treatment.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 5:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The sick need a doctor, and God uses many means to heal.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Pray with each dose. Say a short thanks.
- ☐ Talk with your pastor and doctor. Seek harmony.
- ☐ Read Luke 5:31. Remember who needs a doctor.
- ☐ Do not stop abruptly. Make changes only with your doctor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing medication means my faith is weak": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Faith and care together
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing medication means my faith is weak.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You for medicine and doctors. Free me from guilt, and help me trust You as I use the means You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.